FaujPrep

Physical Test 1: Build Fitness Gradually and Safely

Confirm the current standard first

Physical events and standards can change. Check the latest call letter and official recruitment instructions for the events, required performance, clothing, and reporting details that apply to you. Do not use an old social-media list as your standard.

Establish a safe baseline

If you have a medical condition, past injury, or have been inactive, speak with a qualified health professional before starting hard training. For a healthy beginner, begin below your maximum. Record a comfortable baseline for running or brisk walking, push-ups, core work, and mobility without forcing painful repetitions.

A sensible weekly pattern

- Two easy aerobic sessions: brisk walking or easy jogging at a pace where you can speak in short sentences.
- Two strength sessions: controlled push-up progressions, squats or step-ups, and trunk stability. Stop when form breaks.
- One optional easy session: light movement, cycling, or a relaxed walk.
- At least one full rest day: add more recovery if you are sore or unusually tired.

Space demanding sessions apart. A beginner can use walk-jog intervals: alternate a few minutes of easy jogging with walking, and repeat for 20-30 minutes. Add time or repetitions slowly, not both at once. If pain changes your movement, stop and recover; do not train through sharp or worsening pain.

Example beginner week

This is a general example only; reduce it or get professional advice if it is not appropriate for your health or current fitness.

- Monday: 20-minute easy walk-jog; finish feeling you could do more.
- Tuesday: Two or three controlled rounds of incline push-ups, bodyweight squats, and a short plank; stop before form fails.
- Wednesday: Rest or easy walking.
- Thursday: Repeat Monday, adding only a few easy minutes if recovery was good.
- Friday: Repeat Tuesday with the same clean technique; do not test a maximum.
- Saturday: Easy walk and gentle mobility.
- Sunday: Rest and review how your body responded.

After two or three comfortable weeks, make one small change—slightly longer easy activity or a few additional good-quality repetitions. If soreness, sleep, or performance worsens, hold or reduce the load instead.

Form beats a rushed count

For a push-up, keep head, trunk, and hips aligned; lower under control and use the exact depth required by the official demonstration. Practise sets that end while you can still maintain form. Example: if clean form starts to break at repetition 8, stop at 6-7 for that set rather than forcing five poor repetitions. Your training range is not an official pass mark.

Improve technique

For push-ups, keep the body aligned and lower under control. Use an easier incline or knee-supported variation while building strength, then progress gradually. For running, start easy, keep steps comfortable, and increase distance before trying repeated all-out sprints. Practise only movements permitted by your current instructions.

Track the right things

Record the date, session, effort, sleep, and any pain. A repeatable submaximal session is more useful than a daily maximum test. Every few weeks, repeat the same safe baseline and adjust the plan based on progress and recovery.

Recovery matters

Sleep regularly, drink water according to thirst and conditions, and eat normal balanced meals. Avoid crash dieting, dehydration, unverified supplements, and sudden high-volume workouts. These can undermine performance and increase injury risk.

When to stop

Stop exercise and seek urgent medical help for chest pain, fainting, severe shortness of breath, or other alarming symptoms. For persistent pain or an injury, get qualified advice before resuming.

Reminder

This general plan is not medical advice or an official test standard. Fitness progress varies, and no routine guarantees passing or selection.

Research basis

The WHO physical activity fact sheet (https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/physical-activity) provides general health guidance on activity and strengthening; it is not a Pakistan Army recruitment standard. Check the Join Pakistan Army portal (https://joinpakarmy.gov.pk/) and your call-up instructions for current selection requirements. Publicly accessible information reviewed did not verify PMA Long Course 160 physical events or thresholds.